

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY



ACTOR REPORT

UAT-5918: Silent Intruder in Taiwan's Cyber Battlefield

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Admiralty code

A1

TA Number

TA2025091

Summary

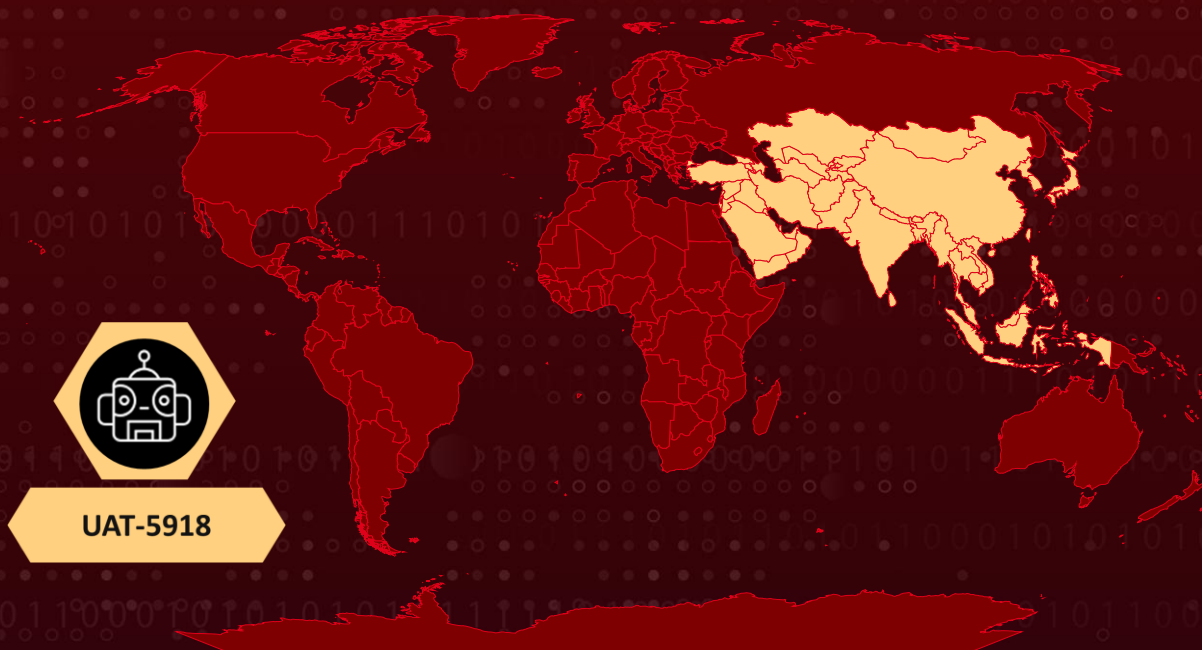
Active Since: 2023

Threat Actor: UAT-5918

Targeted Countries: Taiwan, Asia

Targeted Industries: Critical Infrastructure, Information Technology, Telecommunication Providers, Universities, Healthcare

Actor Map



Actor Details

#1

UAT-5918 is an advanced threat group systematically compromising Taiwanese organizations to establish long-term persistence. They exploit N-day vulnerabilities in unpatched web and application servers to gain initial access, then conduct manual post-compromise activities, focusing on credential theft and lateral movement. They deploy web shells across multiple subdomains and internet-facing servers, allowing them to harvest credentials for both local and domain-level accounts and create new administrative accounts for continuous access.

#2

Their toolkit includes a mix of open-source and custom-built utilities for network reconnaissance and credential harvesting. They use tools like FRPC, FScan, In-Swor, Earthworm, and Neo-reGeorg to tunnel traffic and navigate compromised networks stealthily. Credential theft is carried out using Mimikatz, registry hives, and NTDS dumps, enabling lateral movement via RDP, WMIC, and Impacket.

#3

Once inside a compromised network, UAT-5918 deploys web shells, credential-stealing malware, and red-teaming tools. They use FRP and Neo-reGeorg to establish reverse proxy tunnels for remote access while disabling Microsoft Defender's scanning capabilities to evade detection. Port scanning tools like FScan and In-Swor help identify vulnerable systems, while brute-force tools such as PortBrute attempt to gain access to additional endpoints. They ensure persistence by modifying registry settings, creating new administrative users, and leveraging JuicyPotato for privilege escalation. They also use PuTTY's pscp tool to transfer additional payloads across the network.

#4

Credential theft remains central to their operations, with UAT-5918 extracting login credentials from browsers, registry files, and password managers. They conduct continuous network reconnaissance to discover new targets, using SMB login scripts to pivot further. Another key objective is data exfiltration searching local and shared drives for sensitive files, including confidential documents, database backups, and application configurations. In some cases, they use SQLCMD to create and exfiltrate database backups.

#5

Their tactics align with other Chinese APTs, including [Volt Typhoon](#), [Flax Typhoon](#), and Dalbit, while also overlapping with Tropic Trooper and Earth Estries in the use of port scanners, proxy tools, and reconnaissance techniques, suggesting that UAT-5918 may be of Chinese origin. However, UAT-5918 also employs unique tools like LaZagne, SNetCracker, PortBrute, and NetSpy, which are not commonly associated with other groups.

NAME	ORIGIN	TARGET COUNTRIES	TARGET INDUSTRIES
UAT-5918	-	Taiwan, Asia	Critical Infrastructure, Information Technology, Telecommunication Providers, Universities, Healthcare
	MOTIVE		
	Information Theft, Espionage		

Recommendations



Stay Updated: Keep your web and application servers up to date to prevent attackers from exploiting known vulnerabilities. Focus on patching internet-facing systems first, as they are the most exposed to threats.



Restrict Web Shell Deployment: Monitor for unexpected file changes and use endpoint detection tools to spot web shell activity on subdomains and exposed servers. Stopping web shells early can prevent attackers from maintaining access.



Detect and Restrict Unauthorized Network Activity: Monitor network traffic for suspicious tunneling behavior linked to tools like FRPC, Neo-reGeorg, and Earthworm. At the same time, restrict lateral movement by limiting administrative privileges, tracking RDP and WMIC usage, and implementing allowlisting to block unauthorized hacking tools like Impacket.



Enhance Endpoint Protection: Deploy next-generation antivirus (NGAV) and endpoint detection & response (EDR) solutions to identify and block malware. Leverage behavioral analysis and machine learning-based detection to spot suspicious activity.

Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0042</u> Resource Development	<u>TA0043</u> Reconnaissance	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence
<u>TA0004</u> Privilege Escalation	<u>TA0006</u> Credential Access	<u>TA0007</u> Discovery	<u>TA0008</u> Lateral Movement
<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>T1588</u> Obtain Capabilities	<u>T1588.006</u> Vulnerabilities	<u>T1068</u> Exploitation for Privilege Escalation
<u>T1090</u> Proxy	<u>T1021</u> Remote Services	<u>T1021.001</u> Remote Desktop Protocol	<u>T1590</u> Gather Victim Network Information
<u>T1136</u> Create Account	<u>T1217</u> Browser Information Discovery	<u>T1105</u> Ingress Tool Transfer	<u>T1059</u> Command and Scripting Interpreter
<u>T1003</u> OS Credential Dumping	<u>T1082</u> System Information Discovery	<u>T1592</u> Gather Victim Host Information	<u>T1505</u> Server Software Component
<u>T1505.003</u> Web Shell	<u>T1555</u> Credentials from Password Stores	<u>T1016</u> System Network Configuration Discovery	

Indicator of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	6F6F7AA6144A1CFE61AC0A80DB7AD712440BDC5730644E05794876EB8B6A41B4, BAB01D029556CF6290F6F21FEC5932E13399F93C5FDBCFFD3831006745F0EB83, F7F6D0AFB300B57C32853D49FF50650F5D1DC7CF8111AA32FF658783C038BFE5, 497A326C6C207C1FB49E4DAD81D051FCF6BCBE047E0D3FE757C298EF8FE99ABA, F9EB34C34E4A91630F265F12569F70B83FEBA039C861D6BF906B74E7FB308648, DD832C8E30ED50383495D370836688EE48E95334270CBBCE41109594CB0C9FD1,

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	F7B52EE613F8D4E55A69F0B93AA9AA5472E453B0C458C8390DB963FF8B0B769C, B994CBC1B5C905A2B731E47B30718C684521E8EC6AFB601AFECF30EF573E5153, 12D4EFE2B21B5053A3A21B49F25A6A4797DC6E9A80D511F29CA67039BA361F63, 2272925B1E83C7C3AB24BDEB82CE727DB84F5268C70744345CDA41B452C49E84, 71EB5115E8C47FFF1AB0E7ACEBAEA7780223683259A2BB1B8DB1EB3F26878CA4, E159824448A8E53425B38BD11030AA786C460F956C9D7FC118B212E8CED4087A, 7EF22BFB6B2B2D23FE026BDFD7D2304427B6B62C6F9643EFEDDB4820EBF865AF, EFC0D2C1E05E106C5C36160E17619A494676DEB136FB877C6D26F3ADF75A5777, B7690c0fc9ec32e1a54663a2e5581e6260fe9318a565a475ee8a56c0638f38d0, A774244ea5d759c4044aea75128a977e45fd6d1bb5942d9a8a1c5d7bff7e3db9, 31742ab79932af3649189b9287730384215a8dccdf21db50de320da7b3e16bb4, 09cea8aed5c58c446e6ef4d9bb83f7b5d7ba7b7c89d4164f397d378832722b69, D47e35baee57eb692065a2295e3e9de40e4c57dba72cb39f9acb9f564c33b421, 1753fa34babeeee3b20093b72987b7f5e257270f86787c81a556790cb322c747, F4ea99dc41cb7922d01955eef9303ec3a24b88c3318138855346de1e830ed09e, 5b0f8c650f54f17d002c01dcc74713a40eccb0367357d3f86490e9d17fcd71e8, 3588bda890ebf6138a82ae2e4f3cd7234ec071f343c9f5db5a96a54734eeaf9f, 95eee44482b4226efe3739bed3fa6ce7ae7db407c1e82e988f27cd27a31b56a6, 02ab315e4e3cf71c1632c91d4914c21b9f6e0b9aa0263f2400d6381aab759a61, D1825cd7a985307c8585d88d247922c3a51835f9338dc76c10cdbad859900a03, 234899dea0a0e91c67c7172204de3a92a4cbeef37cdc10f563bf78343234ad1d, 8d440c5f0eca705c6d27aa4883c9cc4f8711de30fea32342d44a286b362efa9a, Ffb8db57b543ba8a5086640a0b59a5def4929ad261e9f3624b2c0a22ae380391

References

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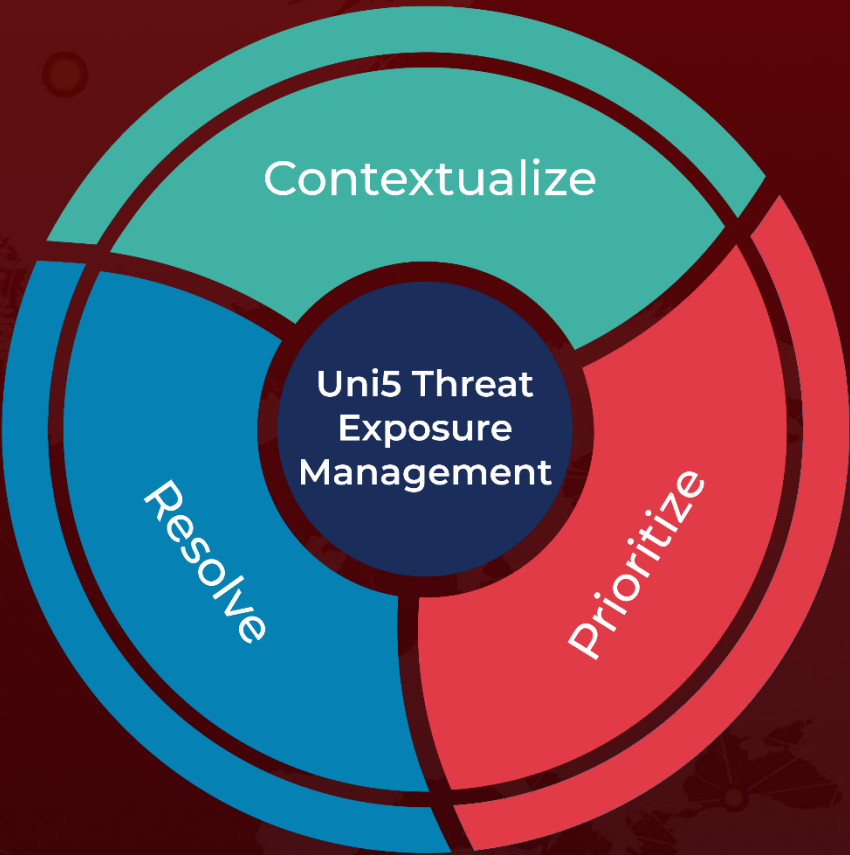
<https://www.hivepro.com/threat-advisory/volt-typhoon-a-cyber-threat-to-u-s-critical-infrastructure/>

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What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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